

Let's start your EB-1A journey!

This form will enable us to collect important information for your case.

Now that we have determined this visa is an option for you, the next step is to share more details about your achievements in your field. This information will help us craft a solid strategy for your petition. While we are confident in our ability to tell your story, we will need your help with the necessary documents and information.

Here's what to do next:

- Follow the instructions in this form to provide all required documents and information.
- Try to answer the questions as completely as possible.
- Upload all requested documents and any additional materials you think might be helpful.
- Providing detailed information and evidence will allow us to prepare a strong case efficiently and meet the expected timeline.
- Completing this form should take about 3-4 hours. You can save your answers using the link below and resume later.

Thank you for your cooperation! We're excited to work with you on this journey.

Personal details

We need this information to prepare your visa forms and related documents.

Full Name	Pranav Khare
Your field of expertise	Digital Identity Verification Products
Country of Birth	India
Country of Nationality	India
Full Name in Native Alphabet	Pranav Khare
Email	khare.pranav@gmail.com
Phone Number	(202) 899-0447
Upload your recent resume or CV	 Resume_PranavKhare.pdf
Upload your passport	 Pranav Khare - Passport.pdf

Upload your U.S. immigration-related documents



NIV (202409) H-1B Approval KHARE,pdf

Do you have any academic degree?

Yes

Please upload copies of your diplomas and transcripts with English translation.

[illegible]

Pranav Khare_Undergrad_Degree andpdf

Once your Green Card becomes available, how would you like to receive your Green Card?

I would likely be in the US, and will apply for a Green Card afterward through the adjustment of status.

Are you now in the United States?

Yes

Mailing address in the United States

13475 NE VILLAGE SQ DR, Unit D-203
WOODINVILLE, Washington, 98072

Your home address outside the United States

E-25, Pallavi Nagar, Bawadia Kalan, Hoshangabad Road
Bhopal, Madhya Pradesh, 462026
India

Name of current employer

Docusign

Current Job Title

Lead Product Manager

Annual Income

\$240,000 + RSU

Do you have any dependents?

Yes

List all your dependents

Full Name	Relationship	Date of birth	Country of birth
Shristi Srivastava	spouse	06-05-1987	India
Miraya Khare	child	11-10-2021	USA

Do you have a Social Security Number (SSN)?

Yes

Have you EVER been a J-1 exchange visitor or J-2 dependent?

No

Have you EVER filed an immigrant petition?

Yes

Please explain:

My employer filed my EB2-PERM on February 20,2024.

Have you EVER been involved in criminal proceedings?

No

Have you EVER been denied a visa to the United States?

No

Have you EVER violated the terms or conditions of your nonimmigrant status?

No

Your future plan in the United States

One of the qualifications of EB-1A is that the foreign person is seeking to enter the United States to continue to work in the field and that this activity will benefit the United States. Please describe how you plan to continue working in the field in the United States. How will your work benefit the United States? Why is it important?

What is best description for your future plan in the United States?

I will benefit the U.S. through working for a specific employer.

Name of your employer or your future company

Docusign

Please describe your proposed endeavor in the United States.

I intend to continue my specialized work in Digital Identity Verification, developing and enhancing secure, compliant, and user-centric solutions that protect against fraud, ensure strict KYC/AML compliance, and uphold privacy standards. Digital Identity Verification lies at the heart of national security, economic resilience, and the protection of democratic values. By guaranteeing that individuals and organizations can be reliably authenticated online, these systems prevent financial crimes, foster trust in digital transactions, and safeguard critical infrastructures across government, healthcare, finance, and more.

Building on my proven track record of pioneering risk-based verification methods and shaping global best practices, I will help strengthen the United States’ leadership in essential digital technologies. My work focuses on creating identity frameworks that are robust yet user-friendly, thus driving broader adoption and maximizing societal impact. In doing so, I aim to reinforce U.S. national interests, as outlined in the 2024 Critical and Emerging Technologies (CET) list, by ensuring that crucial identity solutions meet the highest standards of security, privacy, and accessibility. Through continued innovation and collaboration with U.S. stakeholders, I seek to help the nation maintain its competitive edge, bolster the integrity of digital ecosystems, and preserve democratic values in an increasingly interconnected world.

Why your work could be important to the United States?

Intrinsic Value and Societal Impact:

Protecting Individuals and Businesses: Digital Identity Verification safeguards citizens and enterprises by reducing the risk of identity theft, fraud, and data breaches. This not only saves individuals from financial and emotional harm but also strengthens the broader economy by maintaining consumer confidence.

Supporting Vulnerable Populations: Identity verification solutions help ensure critical benefits and services reach the right recipients - especially low-income families, seniors, and others requiring government or community assistance. By preventing fraudulent claims, resources can be allocated more effectively, directly impacting the well-being of millions.

Enabling Secure Economic Growth: With digital transactions increasingly dominating global commerce, secure identity solutions foster the trust necessary for robust e-commerce, international trade, and banking services. This, in turn, promotes job creation, innovation, and economic resilience throughout the United States.

Defending National Security and Infrastructure: Reliable digital identity frameworks are a cornerstone of cybersecurity. By ensuring only authorized individuals can access sensitive systems or data, these solutions help protect essential infrastructure—such as power grids, healthcare networks, and government services—from malicious actors.

Promoting Democratic Values: Trusted verification methods help maintain the integrity of democratic processes in the digital realm, mitigating misinformation, election meddling, and other abuses. Identity technologies reinforce transparency and fairness, fostering citizen confidence in government and civic institutions.

Examples of Impact:

Fraud Prevention and Cost Savings: Advanced verification solutions save billions in potential losses for financial institutions and state agencies, freeing up funds for public services and investments in research and development.

Improved Access to Services: Secure digital platforms make it easier for citizens to apply for social benefits, educational opportunities, and healthcare services, regardless of geographic or economic barriers.

Stimulation of Innovation: By setting high standards for privacy, security, and usability, the United States can lead global markets in digital identity technology—paving the way for new startups, collaborations, and technological breakthroughs that enhance everyday life.

Collectively, my work addresses critical security, compliance, and user experience needs that benefit individuals, businesses, and government agencies alike. By continuing these efforts in the United States, I aim to fortify the nation's digital backbone, protect its citizens, and promote sustainable, trust-based growth.

Original contribution of major significance 💡

Prove that you have made at least one novel and majorly significant contribution to your field. We'll break down what these terms mean below. A contribution might be an invention, scholarly discovery, or business transaction.

This is a two-part criterion – your contributions must meet both conditions.

Step 1. An original contribution is something you have done that is new and unique. Qualifying examples include an original algorithm, original software architecture, patented technology, or novel go-to-market strategy

For example: if you are a startup founder, the original contribution could be that you created a groundbreaking new app or product. If you have a startup, think about the pitch that you have used for investors as to why your startup is unique. What is your startup trying to solve, and how is your startup different than other startups already in existence? Another example of an original contribution could be a scientist who has completed new research. The work must be groundbreaking or innovative in some way.

Step 2. Your original contribution also must be of major significance in the field. Contributions of major significance have a notable, ideally measurable impact on your field. Notability or impact may look like evidence of commercial transactions, experts using your product, or press mentions.

For example, if you are a startup founder who created an app, the app is of major significance because it has been downloaded 300,000 times throughout the world, and the app ranked as one of the top apps for its category. If you work for a venture-backed company, you may be able to demonstrate that your original work has led to notable success for the company, including its venture funding, awards, press mentions, or industry adoption. Another example of major significance would be a cancer researcher who has researched new strategies to treat cancer that have been already used by others. Why is this work important? What are the real-world implications of this work? How does the work impact the everyday consumer, industry, or field as a whole?

To satisfy this criterion we must explain how your project is novel or innovative and show others already use it. If your work has been implemented, you can supplement evidence in the form of contracts from

customers using your product, blueprints of your work, screenshots of your app, data on the number of customers, and information about the revenue and KPI. If you have an approved or pending patent, this could also be strong evidence of your original contribution. The government does not approve a patent unless your invention is novel. You can provide a copy of the approved or filed patent, with an explanation of what problem the patent was trying to solve, how you solved a problem, and the impact of the patent.

Do you have an original contribution to add?

No

Recommendation letters ✉

We aim to draft around 4-5 reference letters for your petition on behalf of individuals you will provide more information about below. Choosing referrers is an extremely important part of this process; the letters we draft will be the backbone of your petition, so please provide us with as much detail as possible to the prompts below.

We need two types of letters:

1. **Personal Referrers:** Your petition must include reference letters from people who you have a personal relationship with (mentors, investors, colleagues, former professors) and are experts in the field (people who have worked in your industry for years, are thought leaders in your industry, have received press, awards, and/or are otherwise noteworthy in your field). Ideally, we'd like to include referrers who live in different cities around the U.S., as well as a few international referrers, to help show USCIS that you have a national and international reputation.
2. **Independent Referrers:** We'd also want to include letters from referrers who do not know you on a personal level but are familiar with your work (people who work in your industry and know of you in your sphere). USCIS considers these referrers more objective, and therefore, more convincing to your application. Some examples include someone who sat on a panel with you, someone you met at a conference, someone in your field who is not directly involved with your company, but has heard of your company or is connected to someone who is involved with your company, a fellow founder with whom you share the same investor, someone who has used your product and/or someone who knows your co-founder personally, but doesn't know you as well, and can speak about your company's greatness.

How to select an expert to write a letter for you?

We suggest reviewing your connections on LinkedIn and possibly reaching out to someone who works in your industry, to see if they're interested in learning more about your product and signing such a letter for you. Examples can include:

- Founders or co-founders of successful startups (at least at Series A funding stage),
- C-level executives or VPs of large companies (100+ employees),
- academic researchers or professors,
- investors or angel investors,
- large customers, patent holders, government officials,
- leaders of prominent organizations, etc.

It's a good idea to provide a diversified pool of experts, with some of them working in the industry, science, and business.

The USCIS favors letters coming from independent experts who have not worked with you directly (customers, professors, industry leaders). While the nationality of the expert is not a deciding factor, we recommend providing at least one letter from a U.S. citizen.

Referrer 1.

Full Name: Gabriela Moore

LinkedIn Profile:
<https://www.linkedin.com/in/gabimoreore/>

How do you know each other: Direct Supervisor at Docusign

What this letter should focus on?: Critical Role at Docusign

Referrer 2.

Full Name: Sara Harney

LinkedIn Profile: <https://www.linkedin.com/in/sara-harney/>

How do you know each other: Sara was the Product Manager for HHSC and I worked closely with her

What this letter should focus on?: Critical Role in PEBT Project for Texas HHSC

Referrer 3.

Full Name: Rajiv Avacharmal

LinkedIn Profile: <https://www.linkedin.com/in/rajiv-avacharmal/>

How do you know each other: Independent Recommender

What this letter should focus on?: Industry Contribution in Digital Identity Verification

**Critical employment **

For this criterion, we need to show that you have performed in a critical or essential role for organizations that have a distinguished reputation

If you read closely, you might notice that there are actually two parts to this criterion:

- 1. Prove that you are (or have been) employed in a critical role or an essential role
- 2. Prove that your company has a distinguished reputation.

Step 1: Critical or Essential Role

You can provide evidence that you have contributed significantly to the organization OR that the organization requires (or did require) your role to function properly.

If you're a founder you're likely to meet this requirement already. If you occupy a

supportive role, USCIS will need to consider other factors, including the importance of your performance to the organization's overall goals or activities. They may even compare your performance to that of others in similar positions within the organization.

It is not the title but rather your duties and performance in the role that determines whether the role is (or was) critical or essential. You do not need to be directly employed by this organization.

Step 2: Distinguished Reputation

A distinguished reputation means that the company or organization is marked by eminence, distinction, or excellence in the field. Relevant factors for evaluating the reputation of an organization or establishment can include the scale of its customer base, longevity, or relevant media coverage. For academic departments, programs, and institutions, officers may also consider national rankings and receipt of government research grants as positive factors in some cases.

For a startup business, evidence of a company’s distinguished reputation can include its funding history, acceptance into notable accelerators, customer contracts, and partnerships with larger organizations.

Do you have a critical employment to add?

Yes

Provide more information about your role

Company: Docusign

Your job title: Lead Product Manager

Start date: 14 February 2022

End date: NA

Please describe in detail your role, contributions, projects you worked on, and their impact. Upload evidence of this role.

I serve as Lead Product Manager and principal inventor of DocuSign’s new Identity Verification solutions. My work involves designing tools that make sure people are who they claim to be when they sign documents or interact online. I focus on making these tools easy to use, secure, and legally compliant around the world.

My role at DocuSign goes far beyond everyday product management. By creating new identity verification methods and ensuring they are widely adopted, I have been critical to DocuSign’s success. I have directly contributed to increased revenue, improved security, and customer trust, showing that my efforts are essential to both DocuSign’s goals and the broader market need for secure digital transactions.

1. Driving Strategic Revenue Growth and Adoption

Orchestrated a \$70M+ Annual Recurring Revenue Surge -
I spearheaded strategic product enhancements for DocuSign’s authentication solutions, including SMS/Phone authentication and Knowledge-Based Authentication, which collectively generated over \$70 million in incremental annual recurring revenue. By identifying market needs, shaping product roadmaps, and supervising cross-functional teams, I ensured that authentication solutions remained both user-friendly and highly secure, thereby attracting new enterprise clients and deepening existing customer relationships.

Developing Risk-Based Verification to Address Pandemic Challenges - Recognizing the shift to remote work during COVID-19 and the limitations of traditional KBA, I led the creation of Risk-Based Verification - an AI/ML-driven system that dynamically modulates security requirements based on a user’s risk profile. This innovation is projected to contribute \$25 million in annual revenue by 2025, firmly aligning product strategy with evolving customer demands for frictionless yet robust verification methods.

2. Principal Inventor: Pioneering No-Code IDV on the Maestro Platform

Patent-Pending Innovation - As the principal inventor, I played a central role in conceptualizing and integrating Identity Verification within DocuSign’s Maestro platform - an advanced, no-code solution enabling seamless orchestration of verification tools (liveness detection, KBA, SMS authentication, and document checks) into digital agreement workflows. In September 2023, we filed a patent for this novel architecture, underscoring the originality and technological significance of the solution.

Ensuring Global Regulatory Compliance - My role demanded close collaboration with legal and compliance teams to navigate complex international regulations (e.g., KYC/AML standards). I interpreted these requirements, developed robust product specifications, and supervised engineering teams to guarantee the platform conformed to diverse legal frameworks. The success of this patent-pending feature in high-stakes sectors such as finance and healthcare has dramatically reduced fraud and strengthened regulatory compliance for clients, thereby enhancing DocuSign’s trust and brand reputation worldwide.

3. Cross-Functional and Strategic Leadership

End-to-End Product Oversight - My involvement encompassed every phase of the product lifecycle, from early conceptualization and technical validation to launch and market adoption. This holistic scope allowed me to swiftly align user needs, regulatory requirements, and business goals - demonstrating a level of influence and impact rare for product managers in large, established organizations.

Collaboration Across Disciplines - My work required coordinating cross-functional teams including engineers, data scientists, compliance experts, marketing leads, and customer success managers. By bringing these diverse perspectives together, I ensured that security, user experience, and business objectives remained in harmony—key to DocuSign’s industry-leading reputation.

4. Essential Role in Post-COVID Digital Transformation

Meeting a Critical Market Need - In the wake of the global pandemic, remote verification and digital workflows became mission-critical for businesses. My leadership in reimagining identity verification tools established DocuSign as a trusted partner for enterprises seeking to modernize their agreement processes. Clients spanning finance, government, healthcare, and insurance rely on these innovations, reinforcing DocuSign’s market leadership and cementing my role as vital to the organization’s strategic objectives.

Elevating DocuSign’s Global Standing - With widespread deployment and positive industry reception, these IDV enhancements have significantly reduced fraud for end-users and improved compliance post-COVID—two factors instrumental in maintaining consumer and regulatory trust. By spearheading these initiatives, I have contributed to DocuSign’s continued global recognition as the premier solution for secure, seamless digital transactions.

Provide the details of person who could attest to your role.

Full Name: Gabriela Moore

Position: Director of Product Management

LinkedIn: <https://www.linkedin.com/in/gabimoores/>

Relation to you: Direct Supervisor

Do you have a second critical employment to add?

Yes

Provide more information about your role

Company: Deloitte Consulting

Your job title: Senior Consultant

Start date: 8 December 2019

End date: 12 February 2022

Please describe in detail your role, contributions, projects you worked on, and their impact. Upload evidence of this role.

During my time as a Senior Consultant and Product Manager at Deloitte, I played a key role in creating and launching Texas’s Pandemic Electronic Benefit Transfer (P-EBT) program at the height of the COVID-19 crisis. The goal was straightforward yet immense: deliver food assistance to over 3.6 million children who lost access to school meals due to widespread closures. My role at Deloitte went beyond typical consulting responsibilities. I designed the system’s core requirements, coordinated between multiple state agencies, and ensured the final product was secure, user-friendly, and compliant with federal guidelines. By helping deliver over \$1 billion in benefits to millions of families, I demonstrated my ability to drive large-scale, impactful initiatives, reinforcing the critical nature of my work for both Deloitte and the people of Texas.

1. Coordinating a Multi-Agency Effort

I served as the main liaison among the Texas Education Agency (TEA), Texas Department of Agriculture (TDA), Texas Health and Human Services Commission (HHSC), and Deloitte. My work ensured that all these agencies’ needs and rules were aligned, making it possible to roll out the program quickly and effectively.

2. Developing User-Friendly Technology

I gathered program requirements, crafted technical specifications, and wrote detailed user stories so software developers knew exactly what to build. I also focused on intuitive design, which made the online application easy for parents to use, reducing confusion and boosting application success rates.

3. Ensuring Accurate and Timely Benefits

By integrating data from TEA and TDA, we created a system that could confirm each child’s eligibility automatically. This allowed us to distribute over \$1 billion in benefits, helping families feed their children during a very difficult time.

4. Impact on Reducing Child Hunger

In a high-pressure environment, our quick and efficient system made sure millions of children got the assistance they urgently needed. This project showed how innovative problem-solving and technology can directly address pressing social challenges.

Provide the details of person who could attest to your role.

Full Name: Neeraj

Position: Senior Consultant

LinkedIn: <https://www.linkedin.com/in/neeraj-anand-5b30ba47/>

Relation to you: Colleague at Deloitte

High remuneration

Prove that you have, at some point in your career, received a salary and/or equity compensation that places your earnings within the top 10% of professionals within your field, role, and geographic region.

Tips for improving your eligibility

Your compensation must be in the top 10% relative to others working in similar occupations in the field in your country. It is not enough that your salary is just above the average.

Don't worry if you used to make more than you do now - you can meet this criterion by showing any point in your professional history when you were notably well-compensated. We can also show your future proposed salary.

The geographic context can be helpful here. For example, if you work remotely for a company that pays a high salary, you can compare your role to individuals in your geographic location. This can be helpful for roles such as Software Engineers or Chief Executive Officers who are looking to relocate to the U.S.

Equity as a high salary for the founder.

We can also include your equity compensation in your total compensation package. We must show that your equity holdings are highly valued compared to similar companies at this stage. Show your share purchase agreement and evidence of valuations such as SAFE or a valuation report.

If you have yet to meet this criterion.

If you have yet to meet this criteria, there are essentially two paths to achieving it:

- For employees: negotiate a salary within the top 10% range with your employer.
- For founders: allocate a higher compensation to yourself if you own the business.

Do you have a high salary to add?

Yes

Provide more details about your salary in local currency.

Annual salary: (Base - \$209,900) + (Annual Bonus \$31,485) + RSU

Company: Docusign

Job title: Lead Product Manager

Country: United States of America

Upload evidence of your high salary



Promotion Letter US 2024-10-29.pdf



Stock Letter 2024-10-29.pdf



Docusign Federeal W2 FY2024.pdf

Do you have highly valued equity in the startup?

No

Membership

Prove that you are a member of at least one professional organization that values exceptional accomplishments and has admissions requirements. Organizations that qualify typically have reputations for being selective, via competitive or invite-only admissions processes.

For membership to qualify, there must be:

- a **higher selective standard** for admission to the association.
- membership must be in an association that requires outstanding achievements as an essential condition to become a member.
- your outstanding achievements are the basis for granting membership as judged by recognized national or international experts in their disciplines or fields.
- the association must be related to the field of your endeavor.

In fact, any membership in a renowned organization where members are selected or invited on a **qualification basis** may qualify! The submitted evidence should establish that your outstanding significant achievements in the field of business are the basis for this membership in the association. It is not sufficient for this criterion if the membership is based:

- Solely on a level of education or years of experience in a particular field;
- based on test scores or GPA;
- On the payment of a fee or by subscribing to an association's publications; or
- On a requirement, compulsory or otherwise, for employment in certain occupations, such as union membership.

It is also important that we provide good evidence for that, which usually means that the organization should be comfortable with signing the letter of confirmation. To satisfy this criterion, we should show that membership in an association is **exclusive**, which means that membership is limited only to those who have made outstanding achievements in the field as judged by their peers. For example, membership in the *International Business Club* would satisfy this criterion if we would be able to provide a letter stating that membership nominations are based on recognition of your accomplishments in the field. It does not matter where the organization is located.

Tips for founders and entrepreneurs:

An admission into a reputable incubator or accelerator (such as Y Combinator, Techstars, 500 Startups, Plug and Play, Angel Pad) may be positioned as a qualifying membership, provided that there is strong evidence that the admission criteria are highly rigid and require superb achievements of the company's founders/leaders.

Serving on a governing body, such as the Board of Directors/Advisors/Trustees, of any professional association or company may be sufficient to meet this criterion. For a similar reason, participation in a roundtable of well-regarded businesspeople may also satisfy the Membership Criterion.

Do you have a membership to add?

Yes

Organization name

Hackathon Raptors Association

Website

<https://www.raptors.dev/>

Describe the application process, selection rate, and profiles of experts who selected you.

Fellowship is the prestigious Hackathon Raptors membership level awarded only to individuals who have demonstrated recent significant achievement(s) sustained at high levels for a period of at least five years

in engineering, technology, or related disciplines relevant to the Hackathon Raptors.

Fellows must have met at least two of the outlined criteria for at least five of the past ten years.

Confirmation letter possible?

Yes

Upload evidence of your membership.

 Raptors Fellowship Criteria.pdf

 letter.pdf

 certificate.pdf

Do you have a second membership to add?

Yes

Organization name

IEEE

Website

<https://www.ieee.org/>

Describe the application process, selection rate, and profiles of experts who selected you.

To become an IEEE Senior Member, a candidate must self-nominate or be nominated by another member, complete an online application demonstrating at least 10 years of professional practice with 5 years of significant performance in an IEEE-designated field, and provide three references from current IEEE members holding Senior Member or Fellow grade; essentially highlighting their professional achievements and contributions within their technical area through their resume and supporting documentation.

Confirmation letter possible?

No

Upload evidence of your membership.

 SeniorMember_IEEE_PranavKhare.pdf

Do you have a third membership to add?

Yes

Organization name

AI Frontier Network

Website

<https://aifn.co/ambassadors/>

Describe the application process, selection rate, and profiles of experts who selected you.

The AI Frontier Network (AIFN) invites renowned thought leaders and change makers to join as Ambassadors. As an AIFN Ambassador, you're at the heart of our mission to empower our community about the transformative potential of AI. In assessing potential Ambassadors, here's what we look for:

Founders and CXOs of unicorns and soonicorns leading visionary companies with high growth potential, shaping AI innovation on a global scale.

Innovators in leadership roles driving AI-driven projects or initiatives within their organizations, pushing the boundaries of AI innovation.

Thought leaders in AI actively creating and sharing valuable insights on AI through articles, blogs, social media, or research.

Conference speakers regularly presenting at prominent AI and tech conferences, webinars, or industry events.

The AIFN Ambassador network consists of pioneers who leverage their expertise to foster growth and collaboration within the community. Together, we're not only participating in the AI revolution; we're leading it.

Confirmation letter possible?

Yes

Upload evidence of your membership.



AIFN Ambassador Confirmation.pdf

Awards for excellence 🏆

Provide documentation of industry recognition awards or monetary awards that you have earned during your professional career, post-graduation. This is one of the more difficult criteria to meet, so don't worry if you can't. Others will be much easier to complete, like judging and memberships.

You need to provide documentation of industry recognition or monetary awards that you have earned during your professional career, post-graduation.

Types of awards:

1. Industry awards. These include traditional awards, such as official recognition by prestigious groups, such as Forbes 30 Under 30, Fortune's 40 Under 40, The Thiel Fellowship, etc.
2. Venture Funding. Receipt of investment from a venture capital firm can be considered an industry achievement or monetary award. This is actually a common way for startup founders to fulfill this requirement. Don't worry if the check is small! The amount raised is not the most important factor what matters is demonstrating that there has been an investment made in your company.

To meet this criterion, it should be established that the prizes or awards are given to you for your excellence. The award must be national or international in scope, so a local accolade such as the Employee of the Month conferred by a small company represented in one city only would not qualify. The award or prize should be conferred on you or your startup.

If you have received substantial grant funding for research after the grant proposal has been peer-reviewed, particularly if there is an indication that the grant is prestigious or highly competitive (such as a National Institutes of Health grant), such grant funding should be considered an "award." If funding is substantial (\$100,000 and above) and/or the investor is reputable in the business community, we may also present evidence of venture capital funding as evidence of a qualifying financial award.

Examples:

- Awards from well-known national institutions and well-known professional associations.
- Certain doctoral dissertation awards and Ph.D. scholarships.
- Certain awards recognizing presentations at nationally or internationally recognized conferences.

While many scholastic awards do not have the requisite level of recognition, there are some Ph.D. scholarships or dissertation awards, for example, that are nationally or internationally recognized as awards for excellence such that they may satisfy the requirements of this criterion. Relevant considerations include, but are not limited to:

- The criteria used to grant the awards or prizes;

- The national or international significance of the awards or prizes in the field;
- The number of awardees or prize recipients; and
- Limitations on eligible competitors.

For example, an award available only to persons within a single locality, employer, or school may have little national or international recognition, while an award open to members of a well-known national institution or professional organization may be nationally recognized.

Tips for improving your eligibility

- Your awards do not have to be specifically related to your startup. Any awards received at previous organizations can count.
- Look for professional organizations in your field that offer awards. Reach out to them to inquire about the nomination process.
- Use your personal network to find individuals who have received awards in your field and ask them for a letter of recommendation.

Do you have an industry award to add?

No

Have you raised venture capital funding?

No

Judging

Prove that you have judged the work of peers in your field. There are lots of ways you can accomplish this. It is typically one of the easier criteria to work on improving your eligibility.

To win this criterion we need to evidence that you participated on a **panel or individually** as a judge of the work of others in the same or an allied field of specialization. As always, we try to present evidence of more than one qualifying judgeship although one may be sufficient to meet this criterion. The judging should be provided either in the alien's exact field of endeavor or a field allied to it.

The most common instances of qualifying judgeships are:

- Serving as a Judge for a contest, competition, or pitch, whether taking place live or online (Examples: TechCrunch Hackathon, Startup World Cup, Codie Awards).
- Serving as a Reviewer or Member of the Editorial Board for a scholarly or professional publication. The number of review assignments is irrelevant.
- Serving as a Reviewer or Member of the Organizing Committee for a scholarly conference.
- Serving as a Member of a Ph.D. Dissertation Committee, Master Thesis Committee, or any Degree Committee, and
- Serving as an External Evaluator or Judge for a professional organization such as an incubator, accelerator, or any project involving the assessment of professional portfolios.

Evidence of prospective judgeships has no probative value. An invitation to serve as a judge does not suffice; **the judgeship must have already taken place** or be in the process of taking place at the time the petition is submitted.

Tips for improving your eligibility:

If you don't have judging experience already, this is typically one of the easier criteria to work on improving your eligibility. You can search for organizations, publications, accelerators, competitions, or VC firms and ask for opportunities to judge work in a part of their process where your expertise would be relevant and useful.

Ensure that your judgment experience uses the particular field expertise that you want to show. For example, it wouldn't help your case to perform due diligence on healthcare startups at a VC firm if you

want to show fintech expertise. However, this could support your application if you have founded a health tech startup.

Do you have a judging to add?

Yes

Organization: Business Intelligence Group

Website:
<https://www.bintelligence.com/awards/fortress-cybersecurity-award>

Year completed: 2024

Describe your role, selection process of judges, profiles of other judges, etc.

Invited judge for Fortress Cybersecurity Awards 2024

Confirmation letter possible?

No

Upload evidence of your judging



Do you have a second judging to add?

Yes

Organization: Packt Publishing

Website: <https://www.packtpub.com/en-us>

Year completed: 2024

Describe your role, selection process of judges, profiles of other judges, etc.

Technical Book Reviewer

Confirmation letter possible?

No

Do you have a third judging to add?

No

Have you served as as a peer reviewer for any professional publication, proceedings of a conference, thesis or the like?

Yes

List journals or conferences where you served as a peer reviewer.

IEEE Access

Asian Journal of Research in Computer Science

Upload evidence of your judging



PranavKhare_Web_of_Science_Resear... .pdf

Authorship

Show that you have authored at least one peer-reviewed or professional article that relates to your current work in your field - you may be a solo author or included in a group of named authors.

General requirements.

To meet this criterion, you must be a listed **author or co-author** of the submitted article but need not be the sole or first author. In addition, the articles must be **scholarly**. In the academic arena, a scholarly article reports on original research, experimentation, or philosophical discourse. It is written by a researcher or expert in the field who is often affiliated with a college, university, or research institution and the article is normally peer-reviewed.

In general, it should have **footnotes, endnotes, or a bibliography**, and may include graphs, charts, videos, or pictures as illustrations of the concepts expressed in the article. In non-academic arenas, a scholarly article should be written for learned persons in that field.

In evaluating whether a submitted publication is a professional publication or major media, relevant factors include the intended audience (for professional journals) and the circulation or readership relative to other media in the field (for major media).

Self-publications (medium.com, linkedin.com) are very likely to be rejected and should be used only as the very last resort. If your master's degree thesis was published online, we can also consider using it.

Do citations count?

They are helpful but not obligatory. USCIS will not consider examples of applicants being cited as references for peer-reviewed or professional articles. The key factors in qualification are authorship, publication in a qualifying source, and relevance to your field.

If you are not a scientist.

If your occupation is in an industry rather than academia, we may also submit evidence of presentation of your work at a major trade show or conference.

Tips for improving your eligibility.

If you have authored multiple articles, you should only provide articles related to your current work - all your evidence should paint a grander picture that establishes your expertise in a consistent field.

For example, if you're an expert in healthcare technology applying for a visa, your articles should reflect

expertise in healthcare technology and cover relevant topics, like nutrition or technology-related business.

In pursuing opportunities to publish, remember that the quality of your scholarly work matters more than the quantity. We have seen applicants meet this criterion with just one article, and some with several. Aim for a publication with a strong reputation and seek opportunities to write with authors whose work has been cited frequently.

Have you authored any articles in scholarly journal journals, major media or similar outlets?

Yes

Link to Google Scholar or similar

<https://www.researchgate.net/profile/Pranav-Khare/stats>

Citation number (if any)

180

Have you presented your work or served as a speaker at major industry events?

No

Published materials 🗣️

Provide articles that have been published in professional magazines or major news outlets which feature you and your work.

General requirements.

Provide articles that have been published in professional magazines or major news outlets that feature you and your work.

Published material that includes **only a brief citation or passing reference to your work** is not “about” you, relating to your work in the field, as required under this criterion.

However, you and your work need not be the only subject of the material; published material that covers a broader topic but includes a substantial discussion of your work in the field and mentions you in connection to the work may be considered material “about” the beneficiary relating to their work.

Moreover, we may also use material that focuses solely or primarily on work or research being undertaken by a team of which you are a member, provided that the material mentions you in connection with the work, or other evidence in the record documents your significant role in the work or research.

Examples:

- Professional or major print publications (newspaper articles, popular and academic journal articles, books, textbooks, or similar publications) regarding you and your work.
- Professional or major online publications regarding your work.
- Transcript of professional or major audio or video coverage of your work.

In evaluating whether a submitted publication is a professional publication, major trade publication, or major media, relevant factors include the intended audience (for professional and major trade publications) and the relative circulation, readership, or viewership (for major trade publications and other major media).

Tips for improving your eligibility:

1. Leverage your network. Tap into your professional network and connections within your industry. Reach out to colleagues, mentors, and associates who may have connections in the media world. They can introduce you to journalists or editors who might be interested in your story.
2. Become a Valuable Source. Offer yourself as an expert or source for stories related to your field. By

positioning yourself as an authority in your area of expertise, you increase the likelihood of journalists seeking you out for comments, interviews, or feature articles.

3. Engage with Trade Publications. While major national or international publications are essential, don't overlook trade publications specific to your industry. Features in niche publications can also contribute positively to your visa application. Reach out to editors or journalists covering your field in these publications.
4. Build an Online Presence. Maintain an active online presence through professional social media profiles, personal websites, and blogs. Share your insights, research, or achievements to attract the attention of journalists looking for subject matter experts.

Do you have any press articles that mention your name?

No

That's almost everything! 🎉📋

Confirm that what you provided is true and ready to share with the USCIS.

Confirm the below

I hereby certify that the information provided in this form is complete, true, and correct to the best of my knowledge. Further, I understand that incorrect or false information may affect my eligibility for this visa.